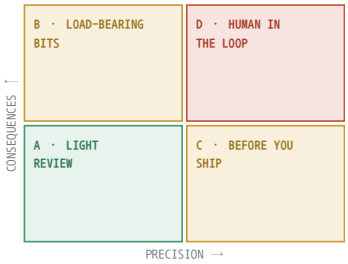
THE HUMAN EDGE · DESK CARD

Same tools. Your judgement is the edge.

Four reusable decision tools for using and delivering AI with judgement. Pin it up; use it on any AI product.

01 Trust tool

How much should I trust this output?



Ask two questions. How exact must it be? What happens if it's wrong?

Check from outside: the data, the source, a colleague, your own sum. "Are you sure?" doesn't count.

Be most sceptical where you know least.

02 RTCF

How do I ask for what I need?

Role who writes it · **Task** what, how much · **Context** audience, situation, stakes, material (does most of the work) · **Format** length, structure, tone.

STILL WEAK? UPGRADE

+ Example show one you liked · **+ Done** define success, allow [CHECK] · **+ Questions** let it ask first · **+ Steps** outline, then draft.

PUSH BACK

Guardrail: `Only change your assessment if I give you a new fact. Name it.` **Devil's advocate:** three reasons it fails. **Board:** CFO, customer, frontline. Long chat? Start fresh.

03 Check loop

How do I know it's right?

Frame write the question; fresh chat → **Explore** describe the data first → **Verify** recount, filter, trace to rows → **Shape** write for the reader; say what you checked. Doesn't hold? Go back.

WATCH FOR

Miscounts · correlation sold as cause · silent gaps · numbers that can't all be true · invented detail.

VET IT

Verify the source yourself · **Explain** it back in your own words · **Test** the edges: when would it be wrong?

04 Opportunity Finder · Deliver

Where does it fit, and will it work every week?

Spot Automate, Assist, Generate, Analyse · **Assign** AI leads, AI assists, you lead, human only · **Prioritise** quick wins first (usually green-corner work).

DESIGN THE HUMAN IN

Scope one workflow, owner, measure, baseline · **Checkpoints** a named person at every B, C or D step · **People** tell them before you start · **Gate** date and criteria, set now.

DAY 30

Scale met the measure, light review · **Pivot** close, check costs too much · **Kill** missed, or errors mattered.

PRACTISE

Two-pass weekly: your rough pass first, then AI's, then compare. Where it beat you is your blind spot.

REVISIT

The corners move as models improve. The check stays: the top-right corner never empties.

BEFORE YOU PASTE

Approved tools first. Leave out what identifies people. Temporary chat for anything sensitive. Your name goes on the output.